Curriculum Vitæ - Vinicius Moris Placco

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Personal information

Full name	Vinicius [v-knee-see-uh-s] Moris Placco
Languages	Portuguese (native), English (fluent), Spanish (intermediate), Italian (basic)
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Employment / Appointments

2024– US National Gemini Office Head – Community Science & Data Center
U.S. National Science Foundation National Optical-Infrared Astronomy Research Laboratory

2022– Associate Astronomer – Community Science & Data Center
U.S. National Science Foundation National Optical-Infrared Astronomy Research Laboratory

2023–2024 US National Gemini Office Acting Head – Community Science & Data Center
U.S. National Science Foundation National Optical-Infrared Astronomy Research Laboratory

2020–2022 Associate Scientist – Community Science & Data Center
U.S. National Science Foundation National Optical-Infrared Astronomy Research Laboratory

2015–2020 Research Assistant Professor – Department of Physics
University of Notre Dame

2018–2020 Faculty Fellow – Liu Institute for Asia and Asian Studies
University of Notre Dame

2014–2015 Science Fellow
Gemini Observatory – Northern Operations Center
Association of Universities for Research in Astronomy

2013–2014 Postdoctoral Fellow
National Optical Astronomy Observatory
Association of Universities for Research in Astronomy

2010–2013 Postdoctoral Fellow
Instituto de Astronomia, Geofísica e Ciências Atmosféricas
Universidade de São Paulo

2010–2011 External Consultant - Data Science and Statistics
Suzuki Veículos do Brasil S/A

2010–2010 Freelance Translator - Astronomy Brasil Magazine
Ediouro Duetto Editorial

Education

2007–2010 Doctorate degree in Astronomy
Search for very metal-poor stars based on carbon over-abundance
Instituto de Astronomia, Geofísica e Ciências Atmosféricas
Universidade de São Paulo

2005–2007 Master's degree in Astronomy
Abundance patterns among very metal-poor stars in the Galaxy: a statistical approach
Instituto de Astronomia, Geofísica e Ciências Atmosféricas
Universidade de São Paulo

2001–2005 Bachelor's degree in Physics (concentration: Astronomy)
Instituto de Física
Universidade de São Paulo

Awards

2024 *Outstanding Achievement Award – Science*
U.S. National Science Foundation National Optical-Infrared Astronomy Research Laboratory
Association of Universities for Research in Astronomy

2011 *Featured Astronomy thesis of the year 2010*
Instituto de Astronomia, Geofísica e Ciências Atmosféricas
Universidade de São Paulo

2005 *Best Astronomy undergraduate project*
Instituto de Astronomia, Geofísica e Ciências Atmosféricas
Universidade de São Paulo

Observatory Experience

Leardership roles/Service

2020–present Hubble Space Telescope External Proposal reviewer
2018–present Member of the J-PAS Survey Science Committee (Javalambre Physics of the Accelerating Universe Survey)
2018–present Co-coordinator of the Resolved Stellar Population Working Group of the J-PAS Survey
2018–present Member of the Maunakea Spectroscopic Explorer (MSE) Science Team
2017–present Subaru Telescope Proposal reviewer – category group: Normal Stars, Metal-Poor Stars
2017–present Member of the S-PLUS Advisory Committee (Southern Photometric Local Universe Survey)
2017–present Principal Investigator of the S-PLUS Short Survey

2019–2020 Member of the NSF NOIRLab Time Allocation Committee - Galactic Panel 2
2017–2020 US representative for the Gemini Observatory Users Committee
2018–2019 Member of the NOAO Time Allocation Committee - Galactic Panel 2
2017–2018 Member of the Gemini OCS Upgrades Working Group
2018 US Extremely Large Telescope Program – First Stars Key Science Project

Operations and Instrument/User Support

2020–present **NSF NOIRLab**: Community Science & Data Center – US National Gemini Office
Product development for the Gemini user community:
Twitter account bots – daily completion, weekly paper, monthly completion, other metrics
GitHub repositories – DRAGONS Imaging tutorials, IRAF Spectroscopy tutorials, users dashboard
Co-organization of AAS Splinter Meetings
Responsible for managing the NOIRLab IRAF modernization project
Migration and maintenance of the US NGO Portal
Migration and maintenance of the GMOS Cookbook
Migration and maintenance of the XDGNIRS Pipeline
Gemini HelpDesk – Responsible for selected Tiers 2 and 3 inquiries

2021–present **NSF NOIRLab**: Communications, Education & Engagement
Supported the migration of the NOAO Science website to the new NOIRLab Science website
Developed, revised, and curated content for the NOIRLab Science website
Serve as a liaison between RSS and CEE
Support science staff in adding/editing content on the science webpages
Responding/routing science inquiries from usercomms@noirlab.edu and info@noirlab.edu
Responsible for the curation of the NOIRLab Capabilities Brochure

2021–2022 **NSF NOIRLab**: Gemini Observatory – Science User Support Department
Part of the Science Verification effort for the DRAGONS spectroscopic routines
Early testing of the quick-look and interactive tools for DRAGONS
Performance comparison between Gemini/IRAF and DRAGONS packages

2014–2015 **Gemini-North**: Operations
Support Scientist for Phase II programs
Backup support for instrument teams
Interface between observatory and visitors (staff, scientists, and others)
Interactions with astronomers, engineers, IT personnel, and facilities staff
Community support (help-desk and troubleshooting)
Write/edit/update internal and external webpages
Weekly operations meetings
Queue observer
Data reductions

2014–2015 **Gemini-North**: GMOS Instrument Team
Instrument performance monitoring pipeline
Throughput characterization
Commissioning of AO capabilities
Write/edit/update internal and external instrument webpages
Data quality assessment
Commissioning of Hamamatsu CCD at GMOS-S

2014–2015 **Gemini-North**: GRACES Instrument Team
Commissioning of the instrument
Developed early data-reduction pipeline
Write/edit/update internal and external instrument webpages
Developed exposure time calculator (GRACES ITC v0.1 Beta)

2008–2012 **SOAR Telescope**: remote observing station – University of São Paulo
Responsible for operations and maintenance
Develop data reduction tools
Edit/write manuals and data analysis cookbooks
User support and troubleshooting
Configure, quote, and purchase new workstations and teleconference hardware
Work with staff and IT personel to ensure access to buildings and computers
Support daytime calibrations / nighttime observations

Observing Experience

Period	Telescope	# of nights	instrument	mode
2019–present	CTIO/Blanco	16	COSMOS	remote
2011–present	ESO/NTT	12	EFOSC2	visitor
2008–present	SOAR	40+	Goodman OSIRIS	remote
2013–2018	KPNO/Mayall	20+	RCSPEC KOSMOS	visitor/remote
2014–2015	Gemini North	12	GMOS GRACES GNIRS NIRI NIFS	queue observer
2014–2015	Gemini South	2	GMOS	remote
2013	McDonald 2.1m	4	ES2 Spectrometer	visitor

Research Experience

Funding

Current

2023–2026 Hubble Space Telescope (Co-I)
Fission of Transuranic Nuclei: A Potential Observational Signature in Metal-Poor Stars
Space Telescope Science Institute (USD 2,873)

Past (Total: USD 475,229)

2025 International Research Network for Nuclear Astrophysics
The 2nd IReNA-Ukakuren Joint Workshop Advancing Nuclear Astrophysics and Beyond
(USD 5,000 - Travel support for conference)

2020–2022 Hubble Space Telescope (Co-I)
Testing r-process nucleosynthesis models with two r-process enhanced stars
Space Telescope Science Institute (USD 35,000)

2019–2021 Hubble Space Telescope (Co-PI)
HD 222925: A unique opportunity to study the full range of nuclei produced by a single r-process event
Space Telescope Science Institute (USD 60,732)

2018–2020 Hubble Space Telescope (Co-PI)
The Unexplored Domains of the s-Process
Space Telescope Science Institute (USD 119,104)

2018 Liu Institute for Asia & Asian Studies (PI)
Stellar Archaeology as a Time Machine to the First Stars
University of Notre Dame (USD 600 - Travel support for conference)

2018 Liu Institute for Asia & Asian Studies (PI)
TDLI Workshop on The Exploding Universe
University of Notre Dame (USD 2,600 - Travel support for conference)

2015–2017 Hubble Space Telescope (Co-I)
The First Detections of Phosphorus, Sulphur, and Zinc in a Bona-Fide Second-Generation Star
Space Telescope Science Institute (USD 85,293)

2016–2017 Faculty Research Support Program Initiation Grant (PI)
Identification of CEMP Stars from S-PLUS Photometry using Artificial Neural Networks
University of Notre Dame (USD 10,000)

2013–2014 FAPESP (State of São Paulo Research Foundation) – Postdoctorate
(re)discovery and analysis of metal-poor stars in the Milky Way
National Optical Astronomy Observatory (USD 71,400)

2010–2013 FAPESP (State of São Paulo Research Foundation) – Postdoctorate
The Milky Way Halo revisited
Universidade de São Paulo (USD 85,500)

Fellowships

2007–2010 Doctorate – FAPESP (07/04356-3) – Universidade de São Paulo
Search for very metal-poor stars based on carbon over-abundance

2005–2007 Master's – FAPESP (05/01023-8) – Universidade de São Paulo
Abundance patterns among very metal-poor stars in the Galaxy: a statistical approach

2004–2005 Undergraduate research project – CNPq/PIBIC – Universidade de São Paulo
Descoberta e Análise de Objetos com Linhas em Emissão no Survey HK

2002–2004 Undergraduate research project – FAPESP (02/04704-8) – Universidade de São Paulo
Construção de câmara de alvo gasoso para produção de feixes radioativos

Visiting Faculty/Postdoc/Graduate Student

2026/2023 Universidade de São Paulo
2022 Instituto de Astronomia, Geofísica e Ciências Atmosféricas
Funding: NOIRLab, USP/FAPESP (Brazil)

2020/2018 Universidade de São Paulo
Instituto de Astronomia, Geofísica e Ciências Atmosféricas
Funding: USP/FAPESP (Brazil), JINA-CEE

2018 Chungnam National University
Department of Astronomy & Space Science
Funding: CNU (Republic of Korea)

2014 University of Notre Dame
Department of Physics
Funding: Gemini Observatory and JINA (Joint Institute for Nuclear Asthophysics)

2014/2012 Massachusetts Institute of Technology
Kavli Institute for Astrophysics and Space Research
Funding: Gemini Observatory, FAPESP (The State of São Paulo Research Foundation – Brazil)

2013/2012 National Optical Astronomy Observatory
Kitt Peak National Observatory
Funding: FAPESP (Brazil)

2013 New Mexico State University
Department of Astronomy
Funding: FAPESP (Brazil)

2010/2008 Universität Heidelberg
Zentrum für Astronomie
Funding: Universität Heidelberg (Germany), FAPESP, PROEX (Brazil)

2010/2009 Michigan State University
2007 Physics and Astronomy Department
Funding: JINA (USA), FAPESP, PROEX (Brazil)

Telescope time allocations

Approved observing projects: 218
Total awarded: 7802.59 hours

*does not include time allocated through university partnerships

Principal Investigator: 55
Total awarded: 1796.05 hours

Co Investigator: 163
Total awarded: 6006.54 hours

Telescope	Proposals
GeminiSouth	87
GeminiNorth	38
SOAR	31
ESO/NTT	10
CTIO/Blanco	9
LCO/Magellan	6
SALT	5
KPNO/Mayall	5
McD/2.7m	4
ESO/VLT	4
NOT	3
LCO/duPont	3
McD/2.1m	2
LNA	2
HST	2
CFHT	2
APO	2
AAO/AAT	2
Subaru	1

Invited / Contributed Presentations

2026

110. Uppsala University – Astronomy and Space Physics Seminar
Stellar Genealogy: The Search for the First Stars and Everything in Between

109. Stockholm University – Astronomy Seminar
Stellar Genealogy: The Search for the First Stars and Everything in Between

108. Kitt Peak National Observatory – Docent in Training Program
The Study of Rainbows

107. Universidade de São Paulo – Astronomy Department Research Update
HE 0144-4657: Finding what you are not looking for

2025

106. Origin of Elements and Cosmic Evolution – Workshop
Neutron-capture in the wild: Finding R-Process Enhanced Metal-Poor Stars in the Milky Way

105. Origin of Elements and Cosmic Evolution – Pre-Workshop School
Stellar Genealogy: Metal-Poor Stars as Probes of the Chemical Evolution of the Universe

104. Kartchner Caverns State Park – Discovery Center Science Talk
A tale of two stars: Revealing the Age and Chemical Evolution of the Universe

103. Kitt Peak National Observatory – Kitt Peak Visitor Center Docent Meeting
Astronomer by Accident: How Serendipity and Diligence Can Shape a Career

102. S-PLUS Collaboration – Bi-weekly Science Seminar Series
The DECam MAGIC Survey: Spectroscopic Follow-up of the Most Metal-poor Stars in the Distant Milky Way Halo – Going on an Informed Fishing Expedition

101. Kitt Peak National Observatory – Docent in Training Program
Spectroscopy for people in a hurry

100. The 2nd IReNA-Ukakuren Joint Workshop "Advancing Nuclear Astrophysics and Beyond"
Neutron-capture in the wild: finding r-process enhanced metal-poor stars in the Milky Way

99. AAS 246 - Stars, Cool Dwarfs, Brown Dwarfs Session
Finding Extremely and Ultra Metal-Poor Stars using Narrowband Photometry from the MAGIC Survey

98. Kavli Institute for Cosmological Physics | The University of Chicago - Open Group Seminars
BD+44°493: Where Near Field Cosmology Meets Exoplanet Science

97. WIYN Board Meeting – Lunch Science Presentation
BD+44°493: Chemo-Dynamics and Constraints on Companion Planetary Masses from WIYN/NEID Spectroscopy

96. Huachuca Astronomy Club – Monthly Science Presentation
A tale of two stars: Revealing the Age and Chemical Evolution of the Universe

95. Kitt Peak National Observatory – Docent in Training Program
Spectroscopy (a.k.a. the study of rainbows)

94. AAS 245 - A conversation about the Gemini Observatory Strategic Plan for the 2030s
GHOST Reduced Data Products for the Gemini Observatory Community and Beyond

93. National Astronomical Observatory of Japan - Science Colloquium
Stellar Genealogy: Rare Gems in the Milky Way as Probes of the Chemical Evolution of the Universe

2024

92. NSF NOIRLab – Users Committee for NOIRLab (UCN)
Aspects of Data Reduction Support at NOIRLab
91. Kitt Peak National Observatory – Docent in Training Program
Spectroscopy for People in a Hurry
90. Nuclear Physics in Astrophysics XI
Neutron-capture in the wild: finding r-process enhanced metal-poor stars in the Milky Way and beyond
89. Rare Gems in Big Data
Stellar Genealogy: Rare Gems in the Milky Way as Probes of the Chemical Evolution of the Universe
88. Kitt Peak National Observatory – Docent in Training Program
Spectroscopy (a.k.a. the study of rainbows)

2023

87. DELVE Collaboration Meeting
How to also find what you are not looking for: going on a fishing expedition
86. XIX J-PAS Collaboration Meeting
An R-process Enhanced Extremely Metal-Poor Star Identified with Narrow-band Photometry
85. International Research Network for Nuclear Astrophysics – Online Seminar Series (watch it on Youtube)
Neutron-capture in the wild: finding r-process enhanced metal-poor stars in the Milky Way and beyond
84. Observatório Nacional – S-PLUS 18th Collaboration Meeting
An r-process enhanced extremely metal-poor star identified by S-PLUS
83. NSF's NOIRLab – NOIRLab South Colloquium
What else can you find when looking for Carbon Enhanced Ultra Metal-Poor Stars? A GHOST Story
82. NSF's NOIRLab – GHOST Webinar Series
How to Find What You Are Not Looking For: The curious case of SPLUS J1424-2542
81. Lund University
What else can you find when looking for Ultra Metal-Poor Stars?
80. NSF's NOIRLab – SWEETS (Support Work Education and Exchange Talk Series)
The US National Gemini Office

2022

79. Centro de Estudios de Física del Cosmos de Aragón – 18th J-PAS Collaboration Meeting
The miniJPAS survey: stellar atmospheric parameters from 56 optical filters
78. NSF's NOIRLab – DECam at 10 years - Looking Back, Looking Forward
Searching for Chemically Pristine Stars with Narrowband Photometry
77. Centro Brasileiro de Pesquisas Físicas – S-PLUS 17th Collaboration Meeting
Mining S-PLUS for Metal-Poor Stars in the Milky Way
76. Planetário da Gávea, Rio de Janeiro – O Céu do Sul e suas Maravilhas
SPLUS J2104−0049 e a Evolução Química do Universo
75. Universidade de São Paulo – Astronomia ao Meio-dia (watch it on Youtube – in Portuguese)
A Tabela Periódica Astrofísica
74. Universidade de São Paulo – Astrophysics Colloquium (watch it on Youtube)
Is Carbon Ubiquitous in the High-Redshift Universe? A Stellar Archaeology perspective
73. Gemini Observatory Science Meeting 2022
Making good use of bad weather: a chemically pristine star found through the clouds with Gemini
72. Observatório Nacional – Seminário da Coordenação de Astronomia e Astrofísica
Stellar Archaeology and Near-Field Cosmology: Understanding the Chemical Evolution of the Universe

2021

71. Universidade de São Paulo – S-PLUS 16th Collaboration Meeting
Mining the S-PLUS catalog to find chemically peculiar stars in the Galaxy

70. Instituto Nacional de Pesquisas Espaciais – Seminários da Divisão de Astrofísica (watch it on watch it on Youtube)
Stellar Archaeology and Near-Field Cosmology: Understanding the Chemical Evolution of the Universe

69. Universidade Federal de Santa Catarina – IX Encontro de Física e Astronomia da UFSC
Stellar Archaeology and Near-Field Cosmology: Understanding the Chemical Evolution of the Universe

68. Joint Institute for Nuclear Astrophysics – Physics of Atomic Nuclei High School Program
The Age and Chemical Evolution of the Universe from Two Stars in the Milky Way

67. *Universidade de São Paulo – S-PLUS 15th Collaboration Meeting*
Searching for low-metallicity stars in S-PLUS

66. *NSF's NOIRLab – Live from NOIRLab @ Hawai'i (watch it on Youtube)*
A chemically-peculiar star found from its colors

2020

65. NSF's NOIRLab – Live from NOIRLab @ Hawai'i (Youtube)
The Age and Chemical Evolution of the Universe from Two Stars in the Milky Way

64. NSF's NOIRLab – Gemini Observatory Science Coffee
From R=40 to R=40,000: Mining narrow-band photometric catalogs in search of low-metallicity stars

63. *Joint Institute for Nuclear Astrophysics – Physics of Atomic Nuclei High School Program*
The Age and Chemical Evolution of the Universe from Two Stars in the Milky Way

62. *Regional Center for Space Science and Tec Education for West Asia / Arab Union for Astronomy & Space Science*
Our eyes in the skies: How telescopes help us place ourselves in the Universe

61. *NSF's NOIRLab Colloquium*
Near-Field Cosmology with Narrow-Band Photometry and Spectroscopy of Low-Metallicity Stars

60. *Universidade de São Paulo – Astrophysics Colloquium*
Near-Field Cosmology using Narrow-Band Photometry and Low-Metallicity Stars

59. *Universidade de São Paulo – Astronomia ao Meio-dia (watch it on Youtube – in Portuguese)*
Agulhas no palheiro: A evolução química e idade do Universo contadas por duas estrelas

2019

58. National Optical Astronomy Observatory
Stellar Archaeology: Understanding the Chemical Evolution of the Universe through Color Maps of the Night Sky

57. *Joint Institute for Nuclear Astrophysics – Physics of Atomic Nuclei High School Program*
The Age and Chemical Evolution of the Universe from two stars in the Milky Way

56. *Consejo Superior de Investigaciones Científicas – 17th J-PAS Collaboration Meeting*
Identification of Low-Metallicity Stars from Narrow-Band Photometry

55. *San Francisco State University – Physics & Astronomy Colloquium*
Stellar Archaeology: Origin of the Chemical Elements in the Universe through a 59-Color Map of the Sky

2018

54. Kavli IPMU at The University of Tokyo – Stellar Archaeology as a Time Machine to the First Stars
The Mass Distribution of the First Stars revealed by Abundance Pattern Matching of Ultra Metal-Poor Stars

53. Kavli IPMU at The University of Tokyo – Introduction to Stellar Archaeology
Radioactive Stellar Ages
52. Texas A&M University Commerce – Physics & Astronomy Colloquium
Stellar Archaeology: Understanding the Origin of the Chemical Elements through a 59-Color Map of the Night Sky
51. Chungnam National University – Department of Astronomy & Space Science Seminar
The Origin of the Chemical Elements in the Universe revealed by a 12-Color Map of the Night Sky
50. Korea Astronomy and Space Science Institute Colloquium
Constraints on Near-Field Cosmology through Abundance Pattern Matching of Ultra Metal-Poor Stars
49. Universidade de São Paulo – Astronomy Colloquium
The Southern Photometric Local Universe Survey (S-PLUS): An Overview
48. Universidade de São Paulo – S-PLUS Meeting
Short update on S-PLUS SHORTS
47. University of Notre Dame – Astronomy 1-minute talks (23 presenters)
Organizer and Presenter
46. University of Notre Dame – Our Universe Revealed
A day in the life of an Astronomer
45. Kavli Institute for Cosmological Physics – Near-Field Cosmology with the Dark Energy Survey
The Age Structure of the Milky Way Halo revealed by DES
44. Joint Institute for Nuclear Astrophysics – Physics of Atomic Nuclei High School Program
Can we talk about the Age and Chemical Evolution of the Universe by looking at only two stars?
43. Centro de Estudios de Física del Cosmos de Aragón – J-PLUS 2nd Virtual Meeting
J-PLUS Stellar Parameter Value Added Catalog
42. Shanghai Jiao Tong University – Tsung-Dao Lee Institute Workshop on The Exploding Universe
Probing the mass distribution of the first stars through abundance pattern matching of ultra metal-poor stars
41. JINA-CEE Frontiers in Nuclear Astrophysics – Main Conference
Observational constraints on the origin of the elements: from First stars to Neutron-Star mergers
40. Manhattan College – Physics Department Colloquium
Understanding the Origin of the Elements in the Universe through a 12-Color Map of the Night Sky
39. JINA-CEE Frontiers in Nuclear Astrophysics – Junior Workshop
Speaking Skills
38. Centro de Estudios de Física del Cosmos de Aragón – 16th J-PAS Collaboration Meeting - Pathfinder science
Constraints on First-Star Nucleosynthesis from J-PAS Photometry of Low-Metallicity Stars
37. Universidade de São Paulo – S-PLUS Collaboration Meeting (online)
Updates on S-PLUS Short Survey(s)

2017

36. Universidade de São Paulo – S-PLUS Collaboration Meeting (online)
Updates on S-PLUS Short Survey(s)
35. Michiana Astronomical Society – MAS monthly meeting speaker
A Tale of Two Stars: Revealing the Age and Chemical Evolution of the Universe
34. University of Notre Dame – Astro-Skills Lunch
The do's and don'ts when plotting data
33. Red de Infraestructuras de Astronomia – Early Data Release and Scientific Exploitation of the J-PLUS Survey
Identification of (Bright) Carbon-Enhanced Metal-Poor Stars with J-PLUS Photometry

32. GMT Community Science Meeting – Chemical Evolution of the Universe
A Monte Carlo approach to find the Progenitors of Ultra Metal-Poor Stars (Rapid Poster Talk)
31. University of Notre Dame – The Great American Eclipse at Notre Dame
Co-organizer / Astronomy faculty representative – 3,500 attendees
30. University of Notre Dame – Research Experiences for Undergraduates (REU) Program
A needle in a haystack: What one star can tell us about the age and chemical evolution of the entire Universe
29. Centro de Estudios de Física del Cosmos de Aragón – J-PLUS 1st Virtual Meeting
Identifying (Carbon-Enhanced) Metal-Poor Stars from J-PLUS Photometry
28. Joint Institute for Nuclear Astrophysics – Physics of Atomic Nuclei High School Program
Stellar Archaeology: The Age and Chemistry of the Universe revealed by old Stars
27. Universidade de São Paulo – Astrophysics Colloquium
Searching for the Origin of the Elements Using a 12-Color Map of the Night Sky

2016

26. University of Notre Dame – Astrophysics Seminar
A Monte Carlo approach to find the Progenitors of Ultra Metal-Poor Stars
25. University of Notre Dame – Department of Physics Colloquium
Searching for the Origin of the Elements Using a 12-Color Map of the Night Sky
24. University of Notre Dame – Astronomy 1-minute talks (19 presenters)
Organizer and Presenter
23. Universidade de São Paulo – X-PLUS Collaboration Meeting
Identifying Bright Carbon-Enhanced Metal-Poor Stars from S-PLUS Photometry
22. University of Notre Dame – Research Experiences for Undergraduates (REU) Program
Near-Field Cosmology with Metal-Poor Stars
21. University of Notre Dame – Our Universe Revealed
A day in the life of an Astronomer
20. University of Notre Dame – Our Universe Revealed
Our eyes in the skies: How telescopes help us place ourselves in the Universe
19. 227th Meeting of the American Astronomical Society
Identifying Bright Carbon-Enhanced Metal-Poor Stars in the RAVE Catalog

2015

18. University of Notre Dame – Our Universe Revealed
The stuff we are made of: how do we determine the chemical elements in stars and the Universe?
17. University of Notre Dame – Astronomy 1-minute talks (15 presenters)
Organizer and Presenter
16. Joint Institute for Nuclear Astrophysics / University of Notre Dame – High School On Air Talk
Stellar Archaeology: The Age and Chemistry of the Universe revealed by old Stars – *YouTube video*
15. Michigan State University – JINA-CEE Nuclear Astrophysics Lunch Research Discussions
Observing the First Stars through the Atmospheres of Ultra Metal-Poor Stars
14. Universidade de São Paulo – X-PLUS Collaboration Meeting
Identifying Carbon-Enhanced Metal-Poor Stars from S-PLUS Photometry
13. University of Notre Dame – Research Experiences for Undergraduates (REU) Program
Galactic Archaeology: The Chemical Evolution and Age of the Universe revealed by old Stars

2014

12. University of Notre Dame – Astronomy Seminar
Exploring the history of the Galactic halo with Carbon-Enhanced Metal-Poor stars
11. Massachusetts Institute of Technology – Kavli Institute
Exploring the history of the Galactic halo with Carbon-Enhanced Metal-Poor stars

2013

10. National Optical Astronomy Observatory
(Carbon Enhanced) metal-poor stars and the chemical evolution of the Universe
9. Gemini Observatory – Northern Operations Center
Metal-poor stars as tracers of the chemical evolution of the Galaxy

2012

8. Universidade Cruzeiro do Sul - Astronomy Colloquium
Search for Carbon-Enhanced Metal-Poor stars in the Halo(es) of the Galaxy
7. Universidade de São Paulo - Astronomy Colloquium
Spectroscopy from R=300 to 30000: metal-poor stars and Galactic chemical evolution
6. Universidade de São Paulo - Invitation to Physics: undergraduate weekly seminar
Arqueologia Galáctica: a evolução química do universo revelada por estrelas pobres em metais
5. Universidade de São Paulo - Astronomy at noon: undergraduate weekly seminar
Census of the Milky Way

2011

4. Universidade de São Paulo - Chemical Evolution Group Seminar
Rediscovering the Dual Halo of the Milky Way via Hierarquical Clustering
3. Universidade de São Paulo - Astronomy at noon: undergraduate weekly seminar
Stellar Archaeology
2. Universidade de São Paulo - Astronomy Colloquium
Making good use of bad weather: finding extremely metal-poor stars in the clouds
1. ESO Headquarters - Santiago - Astronomy Colloquium
Searches for Metal-Poor Stars from the Hamburg/ESO Survey using the CH G-band

Academic Experience

Student/Postdoc supervision

Postdoctoral level

2022–2023 Felipe de Almeida Fernandes (Universidade de São Paulo - Visiting Fellow at NSF NOIRLab)

Graduate Level

2025– Debasish Hazarika (University of Atacama, Chile - Visiting Student at NSF NOIRLab)
2023–2024 Eduardo Machado Pereira (Observatório Nacional, Brazil - Visiting Student at NSF NOIRLab)
2019–2022 Carlos Andrés Galarza Arevalo (Observatório Nacional - Brazil)
2019–2022 Joseph Zepeda (University of Notre Dame)
2019–2022 Derek Shank (University of Notre Dame)
2015–2020 Sarah Dietz (University of Notre Dame)
2015–2020 Dmitrii Gudin (University of Notre Dame)
2015–2020 Devin Whitten (University of Notre Dame)
2015–2020 Kaitlin Rasmussen (University of Notre Dame)
2015–2017 Geoffrey Lentner (University of Notre Dame)
2010–2016 Rafael Santucci (M.Sc. and Ph.D. - Universidade de São Paulo)

Undergraduate Level - University of Notre Dame

2020 Dante Komater (Physics Major)
2019–2020 Lucas Pinheiro (Engineering Major)
2019 Shenghua Liu (Physics Major)
2019 Winter Allen (Arkansas Tech University - REU)
2019 Yihao Zhou (Shanghai Jiao Tong University - REU)
2016–2018 Erik Peterson
2016–2018 David Kalamarides
2015–2018 Spencer Clark (Glynn Family Honors Program) - Senior Thesis
2016–2017 John Roach
2016–2017 Cristobal Gonzales
2016–2017 Michael Kurkowski
2017 Jazmine Jefferson (University of Kansas - REU)
2017 Derek Shank (Ohio Wesleyan University - DISC/REU) - video report
2017 Diego Fernandez (University of Oregon - REU)
2016 Travis Hodges (Austin Peay State University - DISC/REU)
2016 Miguel Correa (San Diego State University - REU)
2015 Siyu He (Xi'an Jiaotong University - REU)
2012–2014 William Alves (Universidade de São Paulo)
2008–2010 Rafael Santucci (Universidade de São Paulo)

Committee Service - University of Notre Dame

2019–2020 Undergraduate Research, Department of Physics
2016–2018 Graduate Recruitment, Department of Physics
2015–2018 Preliminary Exam Committee, Department of Physics
2015–2018 University Committee on Research & Sponsored Programs, Notre Dame Research

Thesis Defense Committee

2025 Eduardo Machado Pereira (Ph.D.)
Observatório Nacional
2024 Paulo Cesar Vargas Junior (M.Sc.)
Universidade Federal de Goiás
2024 Guilherme Limberg (Ph.D.)
Universidade de São Paulo
2024 Franklin T. S. Sampaio (M.Sc.)
Universidade Federal de Goiás
2024 Fábio Carneiro Wanderley (Ph.D.)
Observatório Nacional
2024 Elvis William Carvalho Cantelli (Ph.D.)
Universidade de São Paulo
2023 Yuri Abuchaim de Oliveira (M.Sc.)
Universidade de São Paulo
2023 Fabricia Oliveira Barbosa (M.Sc.)
Universidade de São Paulo
2018–2022 Heitor Ernandes (Ph.D. - committee chair)
Universidade de São Paulo
2021 Raphaela Fernandes de Melo (M.Sc.)
Observatório Nacional
2019 Henrique Reggiani (Ph.D.)
Universidade de São Paulo
2016 Rafael Miloni Santucci (Ph.D.)
Universidade de São Paulo
2016 Camilo Francisco Javier Muñoz Peña (M.Sc.)
Universidade de São Paulo

Organizing Committee - Conferences and Workshops

2024 Rare Gems in Big Data
NSF NOIRLab
2022 DECam at 10 years - Looking Back, Looking Forward
NSF NOIRLab

Teaching

Lead Instructor (LI) / Co-Instructor (CI) / Guest Lecturer (GL)

Undergraduate

		University of Notre Dame
2020	(LI)	Descriptive Astronomy (SU20-PHYS-10140)
		Course Instructor Feedback: 5.0/5.0 - link to full report
	(LI)	Descriptive Astronomy (SP20-PHYS-10140)
		Course Instructor Feedback: 5.0/5.0 - link to full report
	(LI)	General Physics B - E & M Laboratory (SP20-PHYS-11422)
		Course Instructor Feedback: 5.0/5.0 - link to full report
	(GL)	Engineering Physics II Laboratory (SP20-PHYS-11320)
	(GL)	Engineering Physics I Laboratory (SP20-PHYS-11310)
2019	(LI)	Physics A - Mechanics Laboratory (FA19-PHYS-11411)
		Course Instructor Feedback: 5.0/5.0 - link to full report
	(LI)	Descriptive Astronomy (SU19-PHYS-10140)
		Course Instructor Feedback: 5.0/5.0 - link to full report
2018	(GL)	Descriptive Astronomy (FA18-PHYS-10140)
2017	(CI)	Descriptive Astronomy (FA17-PHYS-10140)
	(LI)	General Physics B - E & M Laboratory (SP17-PHYS-11422)
		Course Instructor Feedback: 4.8/5.0 - link to full report
2016	(GL)	Descriptive Astronomy (FA16-PHYS-10140)
2015	(GL)	Modern Observational Techniques (FA15-PHYS-30481)
		Universidade Virtual do Estado de São Paulo
2012	(LI)	Sky and Stars: An introduction
	(LI)	Galaxies: An introduction
2011	(LI)	Sky and Stars: An introduction
	(LI)	Galaxies: An introduction

Graduate

		University of Notre Dame
2017	(CI)	Astrophysics: Stars (SP17-PHYS-80202)
2016	(CI)	Large-Scale Astronomical Surveys (SP16-PHYS-70210)
2015	(GL)	Astrophysics: Stars (SP15-PHYS-80202)
		Universidade de São Paulo
2012	(GL)	Observational Astronomy

Teaching Assistant - Universidade de São Paulo

2009	Introduction to Astronomy
	Fundamental Astronomy
2008	Introduction to Astronomy
2007	Fundamental Astronomy

Other relevant information

Technical skills

Linux/Unix/MACOSX/Windows operating systems
Shell Scripting (sh, bash, tcsh, zsh)
LaTeX, OpenOffice, MS Office. Co-author of the LaTeXtemplate IAGTESE
Python (iPython/Jupyter Notebooks): scipy, numpy, pandas, scikitlearn, pyfits, astropy
R-project (terminal/RStudio): FITSio, tidyverse, cluster, sciviews
Databases: SQL (PostgreSQL/pgAdmin3), SDSS CasJobs, ADQL (J-PLUS/J-PAS/TAPVizieR)
Web: html, ccs, wordpress, apache, curl, wget, ssh, ftp, drupal, Google Analytics, Matomo
Graphics: Gnuplot, ggplot2, matplotlib, bokeh, tableau
Data reduction: IRAF/Pyraf packages, DRAGONS, ESO Reflex/Gasgano
Astronomy tools: WCSTools, CDSclient, STILTS, SkyCalc
Documentation: Sphinx, readthedocs
Version control and DevOps: Git, GitHub, GitLab

Online Resources

Webpage:	http://vmplacco.github.io/
LinkedIn:	https://www.linkedin.com/in/vinicius-placco/
GitHub:	https://github.com/vmplacco/
stackoverflow:	https://stackoverflow.com/users/5964833/vinicius-placco
pythonanywhere:	https://vplacco.pythonanywhere.com/
Sample webpages/ side projects:	http://vmplacco.github.io/#resources

Professional Affiliations/Service

Member of the American Astronomical Society
Member of the Brazilian Astronomical Society
Member of the Brazilian Physical Society
Member of the JINA Center for the Evolution of the Elements

Referee for The Astronomy and Astrophisics Review
Referee for the American Astronomical Society Journals
Referee for the AAAS Science Magazine
Referee for Astronomy & Astrophysics
Referee for Monthly Notices of the Royal Astronomical Society
Referee for Astronomy & Computing

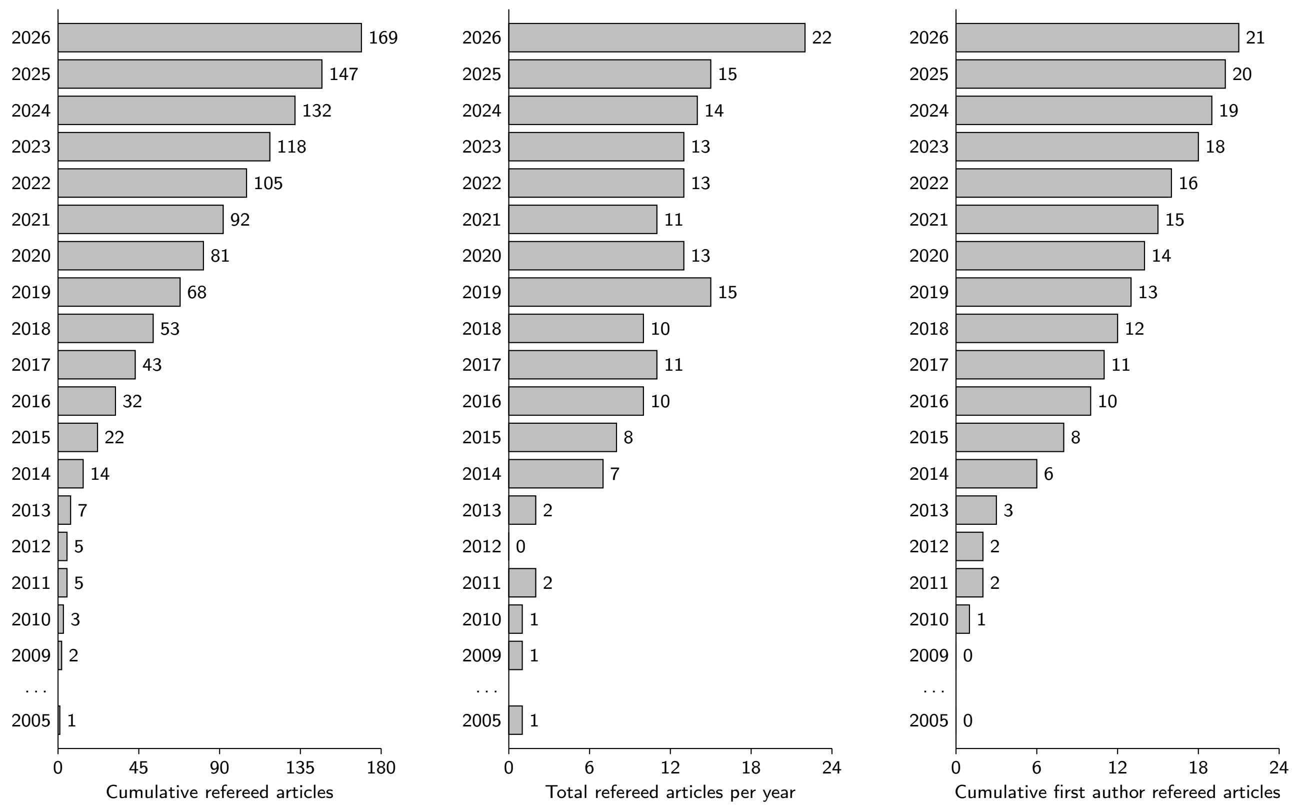
Quantitative Indicators

- astrophysics data system (June 11, 2026 - ADS link)
  - **11840 citations (1253 as first author)**
  - **h-index = 50 (18 as first author)**
  - **i10-index = 125 (19 as first author)**
- Google Scholar (June 11, 2026 - Google Scholar link)
  - **14638 citations**
  - **h-index = 51**
  - **i10-index = 121**
- ADS Publication Lists
  - Complete - ADS link
  - Refereed only - ADS link
- ORCID iD - 0000-0003-4479-1265

Publication list

Refereed articles

Total: 169 publications (including 21 first, 16 second, and 20 third author articles)



First Author (⋆ for relevant non-refereed publications)

21. **Placco, V. M.**, Limberg, G., Kennedy, C., Christlieb, N.
HE 0144−4657: A Carbon-Enhanced Ultra Metal-Poor Star ([Fe/H]∼ -4.1) from the Helmi Stream Disrupted Dwarf Galaxy
2026, **The Astrophysical Journal Letters**, vol. 1000, L34 (ADS)

20. **Placco, V. M.**, Limberg, G., Chiti, A., Prabhu, D. S., Ji, A. P., Barbosa, F. O., Cerny, W., Pace, A. B., Stringfellow, G. S., Sand, D. J., Martínez-Vázquez, C. E., Riley, A. H., Rossi, S., Noël, N. E. D., Vivas, A. K., Medina, G. E., Drlica-Wagner, A., Sakowska, J. D., Mutlu-Pakdil, B., Massana, P., Carballo-Bello, J. A., Choi, Y., Crnojević, D., Tan, C. Y.
The DECam MAGIC Survey: Spectroscopic Follow-up of the Most Metal-Poor Stars in the Distant MW Halo
2025, **The Astrophysical Journal**, vol. 991, 101 (ADS)

19. **Placco, V. M.**, Gupta, A. F., Almeida-Fernandes, F., Logsdon, S. E., Rajagopal, J., Holmbeck, E. M., Roederer, I. U., Della Costa, J., Fernandez, P., Golub, E., Higuera, J., Patel, Y., Ridgway, S., Schweiker, H.
BD+44°493: Chemo-Dynamical Analysis and Constraints on Companion Planetary Masses from WIYN/NEID Spectroscopy
2024, **The Astrophysical Journal**, vol. 977, 12 (ADS)

⋆ **Placco, V. M.**, Herrera, D., Merino, B. M., Hirst, P., Labrie, K., Simpson, C., Turner, J., Vacca, W. D., Deibert, E., Diaz, R., Heo, J., Kalari, V., Reggiani, H., Rodriguez, C., Ruiz-Carmona, R., Thomas-Osip, J.
GHOST Reduced Data Products for the Gemini Observatory Community and Beyond
2024, **Research Notes of the American Astronomical Society**, vol. 8, 12 (ADS)

18. **Placco, V. M.**, Almeida-Fernandes, F., Holmbeck, E. M., Roederer, I. U., Mardini, M. K., Hayes, C. R., Venn, K., Chiboucas, K., Deibert, E., Gamen, R., Heo, J., Jeong, M., Kalari, V., Martioli, E., Xu, S., Diaz, R., Gomez-Jimenez, M., Henderson, D., Prado, P., Quiroz, C., Ruiz-Carmona, R., Simpson, C., Urrutia, C., McConnachie, A. W., Pazder, J., Burley, G., Ireland, M., Waller, F., Berg, T. A. M., Robertson, J. G., Hartman, Z., Jones, D. O., Labrie, K., Perez, G., Ridgway, S., Thomas-Osip, J.
SPLUS J142445.34−254247.1: An R-Process Enhanced, Actinide-Boost, Extremely Metal-Poor star observed with GHOST
2023, **The Astrophysical Journal**, vol. 959, 60 (ADS)

17. **Placco, V. M.** & Stanghellini, L.
US National Gemini Office in the NOIRLab era
2023, **Journal of Astronomical Telescopes, Instruments, and Systems**, vol. 9, 7003 (ADS)

16. **Placco, V. M.**, Almeida-Fernandes, F., Arentsen, A., Lee, Y. S., Schoenell, W., Ribeiro, T., Kanaan, A.
Mining S-PLUS for Metal-Poor Stars in the Milky Way
2022, **The Astrophysical Journal Supplement Series**, vol. 262, 8 (ADS)

15. **Placco, V. M.**, Roederer, I. U., Lee, Y. S., Almeida-Fernandes, F., Herpich, F. R., Perottoni, H. D., Schoenell, W., Ribeiro, T., Kanaan, A.
SPLUS J210428.01−004934.2: An Ultra Metal-Poor Star Identified from Narrow-Band Photometry
2021, **The Astrophysical Journal Letters**, vol. 912, 32 (ADS)

⋆ **Placco, V. M.**, Sneden, C., Roederer, I. U., Lawler, J. E., Den Hartog, E. A., Hejazi, N., Maas, Z., Bernath, P.
linemake: an Atomic and Molecular Line List Generator
2021, **Research Notes of the American Astronomical Society**, vol. 5, 92 (ADS | PDF)

14. **Placco, V. M.**, Santucci, R. M., Yuan, Z., Mardini, M. K., Holmbeck, E. M., Wang, X., Surman, R., Hansen, T., Roederer, I. U., Beers, T., Choplin, A., Ji, A., Ezzeddine, R., Frebel, A., Sakari, C., Whitten, D., Zepeda, J.
The R-Process Alliance: The Peculiar Chemical Abundance Pattern of RAVE J183013.5−455510
2020, **The Astrophysical Journal**, vol. 897, 78 (ADS)

13. **Placco, V. M.**, Santucci, R. M., Beers, T. C., Chanamé, J., Sepúlveda, M. P., Coronado, J., Rossi, S., Lee, Y. S., Starkenburg, E., Youakim, K., Barrientos, M., Ezzeddine, R., Frebel, A., Hansen, T. T., Holmbeck, E. M., Ji, A. P., Rasmussen, K. C., Roederer, I. U., Sakari, C. M., Whitten, D. D.
The R-Process Alliance: Spectroscopic Follow-up of 857 Low-Metallicity Star Candidates from the Best & Brightest Survey
2019, **The Astrophysical Journal**, vol. 870, 122 (ADS)

12. **Placco, V. M.**, Beers, T. C., Santucci, R. M., Chanamé, J., Sepúlveda, M. P., Coronado, J., Points, S. D., Kaleida, C. C., Rossi, S., Kordopatis, G., Lee, Y. S., Matijevič, G., Frebel, A., Hansen, T. T., Holmbeck, E. M., Rasmussen, K. C., Roederer, I. U., Sakari, C. M., Whitten, D. D.
Spectroscopic Validation of Low-Metallicity Stars from RAVE
2018, **The Astronomical Journal**, vol. 155, 256 (ADS)

11. **Placco, V. M.**, Holmbeck, E. M., Frebel, A., Beers, T. C., Surman, R. A., Ji, A. P., Ezzedine, R., Points, S. D., Kaleida, C. C., Hansen, T. T., Sakari, C. M., Casey, A. R.
RAVE J203843.2−002333: The First Highly R-process-enhanced Star Identified in the RAVE Survey.
2017, **The Astrophysical Journal**, vol. 844, 18 (ADS)

10. **Placco, V. M.**, Frebel, A., Beers, T. C., Yoon, J., Chiti, A., Heger, A. Chan, C., Casey, A. R., Christlieb, N.
Observational Constraints on First-Star Nucleosynthesis. II. Spectroscopy of an Ultra Metal-Poor CEMP-no Star
2016, **The Astrophysical Journal**, vol. 833, 21 (ADS)

9. **Placco, V. M.**, Beers, T. C., Reggiani, H., Meléndez, J.
G64−12 and G64−37 are Carbon-Enhanced Metal-Poor Stars
2016, **The Astrophysical Journal Letters**, vol. 829, 24 (ADS)

8. **Placco, V. M.**, Beers, T. C., Ivans, I. I., Filler, D., Imig, J. A., Roederer, I., Abate, C., Hansen, T., Cowan, J., Frebel, A., Lawler, J. E., Schatz, H., Sneden, C., Sobeck, J., Aoki, W., Smith, V. V., Bolte, M.
Hubble Space Telescope Near-Ultraviolet Spectroscopy of the Bright CEMP-s Stars
2015, **The Astrophysical Journal**, vol. 812, 109 (ADS)

7. **Placco, V. M.**, Frebel, A., Lee, Y. S., Jacobson, H. R., Beers, T. C., Pena, J. M., Chan, C., Heger, A.
Metal-poor Stars Observed with the Magellan Telescope. III. New Extremely and Ultra Metal-Poor Stars from SDSS/SEGUE and Insights on the Formation of Ultra Metal-Poor Stars
2015, **The Astrophysical Journal**, vol. 809, 136 (ADS)

6. **Placco, V. M.**, Beers, T. C., Frebel, A., Stancliffe R.
Carbon-Enhanced Metal-Poor Star Frequencies in the Galaxy: Corrections for the Effect of Evolutionary Status on Carbon Abundances
2014, **The Astrophysical Journal**, vol. 797, 21 (ADS)

5. **Placco, V. M.**, Beers, T. C., Roederer, I., Cowan, J., Frebel, A., Filler, D., Ivans, I. I., Lawler, J. E., Schatz, H., Sneden, C., Sobeck, J., Aoki, W., Smith, V. V.
Hubble Space Telescope Near-Ultraviolet Spectroscopy of the Bright CEMP-no Star BD+44°493
2014, **The Astrophysical Journal**, vol. 790, 34 (ADS)

4. **Placco, V. M.**, Frebel, A., Beers, T. C., Christlieb, N., Lee, Y. S., Kennedy, C. R., Rossi, S., Santucci, R.
Metal-poor Stars Observed with the Magellan Telescope. II. Discovery of Four Stars with [Fe/H]≤ -3.5
2014, **The Astrophysical Journal**, vol. 781, 40 (ADS)

3. **Placco, V. M.**, Frebel A., Beers T. C., Karakas A., Kennedy C. R., Rossi S., Christlieb N., Stancliffe R.
Metal-Poor Stars Observed with the Magellan Telescope I. Constraints on Progenitor Mass and Metallicity of AGB Stars Undergoing s-Process Nucleosynthesis
2013, **The Astrophysical Journal**, vol. 770, 104 (ADS)

2. **Placco, V. M.**, Kennedy C.R., Beers T.C., Christlieb N., Rossi S., Sivarani T., Lee Y.S., Reimers D., Wisotzki L.
Searches for Metal-Poor Stars from the Hamburg/ESO Survey using the CH G-band
2011, **The Astronomical Journal**, vol. 142, 188 (ADS)

1. **Placco, V. M.**, Kennedy C.R., Rossi S., Beers T.C., Lee Y.S., Christlieb N., Sivarani T., Reimers D., Wisotzki L.
A Search for Unrecognized Carbon-Enhanced Metal-Poor Stars in the Galaxy
2010, **The Astronomical Journal**, vol. 139, 1051 (ADS)

Second Author (⋆ for relevant non-refereed publications)

16. Chiti, A., **Placco, V. M.**, Pace, A., Ji, A., Prabhu, D., Cerny, W., Limberg, G., Stringfellow, G., Drlica-Wagner, A., Atzberger, K., Choi, Y., Crnojević, D., Ferguson, P., Kallivayalil, N., Noël, N., Riley, A., Sand, D., Simon, J., Walker, A., Bom, C., Carballo-Bello, J., James, D., Martínez-Vázquez, C., Medina, G., Vivas, K.
A second-generation star in a relic dwarf galaxy
2026, **Nature Astronomy**, s41550-026-02802-z (ADS)

15. Roederer, I. U., **Placco, V. M.**, Karakas, A. I., Den Hartog, E. A., Beers, T. C.
Abundances of Rarely Detected s-process Elements Derived from the Ultraviolet Spectrum of the s-process-enhanced Metal-poor Star HD 196944
2025, **The Astrophysical Journal**, vol. 995, 2 (ADS)

14. Limberg, G., **Placco, V. M.**, Ji, A. P., Yao, Y., Chiti, A., Mardini, M. K., Frebel, A., Rossi, S.
Discovery of an [Fe/H]~ -4.8 Star in Gaia XP Spectra
2025, **The Astrophysical Journal Letters**, vol. 989, 18 (ADS)

⋆ Fitzpatrick, M., **Placco, V. M.**, Bolton, A., Merino, B., Ridgway, S., Stanghellini, L.
Modernizing IRAF to Support Gemini Data Reduction
2025, **Astronomical Data Analysis Software & Systems XXXIII** (ADS)

13. Perottoni, H. D., **Placco, V. M.**, Almeida-Fernandes, F., Herpich, F. R., Rossi, S., Beers, T., Smiljanic, R., Amarante, J., Limberg, G., Werle, A., Rocha-Pinto, H., Beraldo e Silva, L., Daflon, S., Alvarez-Candal, A., Schoenell, W., Ribeiro, T., Kanaan, A.
The S-PLUS Ultra-Short Survey: First Data Release
2024, **Astronomy & Astrophysics**, vol. 691, 138 (ADS)

12. Almeida-Fernandes, F., **Placco, V. M.**, Rocha-Pinto, H. J., Borges Fernandes, M., Limberg, G., Beraldo e Silva, L., Amarante, J., Perottoni, H. D., Overzier, R., Schoenell, W., Ribeiro, T., Kanaan, A., Mendes de Oliveira, C.
Chemodynamical Properties and Ages of Metal-Poor Stars in S-PLUS
2023, **Monthly Notices of the Royal Astronomical Society**, vol. 523, 2934 (ADS)

11. Arentsen, A., **Placco, V. M.**, Lee, Y. S., Aguado, D. S., Martin, N. F., Starkenburg, E., Yoon, J.
On the inconsistency of [C/Fe] abundances and the fractions of carbon-enhanced metal-poor stars among various stellar surveys
2022, **Monthly Notices of the Royal Astronomical Society**, vol. 515, 4082 (ADS)

10. Whitten, D. D., **Placco, V. M.**, Beers, T., An, D., Lee, Y. S., Almeida-Fernandes, F., Herpich, F., Daflon, S., Barbosa, C., Perottoni, H., Rossi, S., Tissera, P., Yoon, J., Schoenell, W., Ribeiro, T., Kanaan, A., Youakim, K.
The Photometric Metallicity and Carbon Distributions of the Milky Way's Halo and Solar Neighborhood from S-PLUS Observations of SDSS Stripe 82
2021, **The Astrophysical Journal**, vol. 912, 147 (ADS)

9. Mardini, M. K., **Placco, V. M.**, Meiron, Y., Ishchenko, M., Avramov, B., Mazzarini, M., Berczik, P., Arca Sedda, M., Beers, T. C., Frebel, A., Taani, A., Donnari, M., Al-Wardat, M. A., Zhao, G.
Cosmological Insights into the Early Accretion of r-Process-Enhanced stars. I. A Comprehensive Chemodynamical Analysis of LAMOST J1109+0754
2020, **The Astrophysical Journal**, vol. 903, 88 (ADS)

8. Mardini, M. K., **Placco, V. M.**, Taani, A., Li, H., Zhao, G.
Metal-Poor Stars Observed with the Automated Planet Finder Telescope. II. Chemodynamical Analysis of Six Low-Metallicity Stars in the Halo System of the Milky Way
2019, **The Astrophysical Journal**, vol. 882, 27 (ADS)

7. Whitten, D. D., **Placco, V. M.**, Beers, T. C., Chies-Santos, A. L., Bonatto, C., Varela, J., Cristóbal-Hornillos, D., Ederoclite, A., Akras, S., Caballero, J. A., Coelho, P., Costa-Duarte, M. V., Borges Fernandes, M., Lopes de Oliveira, R., Orsi, A. A., Vázquez Ramió, H., Rossi, S., Cenarro, A. J., Daflon, S., Dupke, R. A., Marín-Franch, A., Mendes de Oliveria, C., Moles, M., Sodré, L.
J-PLUS: Identification of Low-Metallicity Stars with Artificial Neural Networks using SPHINX
2019, **Astronomy & Astrophysics**, vol. 622, A182 (ADS)

6. Sakari, C. M., **Placco, V. M.**, Farrell, E. M., Roederer, I. U., Wallerstein, G., Beers, T. C., Ezzeddine, R., Frebel, A., Hansen, T. T., Holmbeck, E. M., Sneden, C., Cowan, J. J., Venn, K. A., Davis, C. E., Matijevič, G., Wyse, R., Bland-Hawthorn, J., Chiappini, C., Freeman, K. C., Gibson, B. K., Grebel, E. K., Helmi, A., Kordopatis, G., Kunder, A., Navarro, J., Reid, W., Seabroke, G., Steinmetz, M., Watson, F.
The R-*Process Alliance: First Release from Northern Search for R-Process-Enhanced Stars in the Galactic Halo*
2018, **The Astrophysical Journal**, in vol. 868, 110 (ADS)

5. Sakari, C. M., **Placco, V. M.**, Hansen, T. T., Holmbeck, E. M., Beers, T. C., Frebel, A. F., Roederer, I. U., Venn, K. A., Wallerstein, G., Davis, C. E., Farrell, E., Yong, D.
The r-process Pattern of a Bright, Highly r-process-enhanced Metal-poor Halo Star at [Fe/H]~ -2
2018, **The Astrophysical Journal Letters**, vol. 854, 20 (ADS)

4. Beers, T. C., **Placco, V. M.**, Carollo, D., Rossi, S., Lee, Y. S., Frebel, A., Norris, J. E., Dietz, S., Masseron, T.
Bright Metal-Poor Stars from the Hamburg/ESO Survey. II. A Chemodynamical Analysis
2017, **The Astrophysical Journal**, vol. 835, 81 (ADS)

3. Roederer, I. U., **Placco, V. M.**, Beers, T. C.
Detection of Phosphorus, Sulphur, and Zinc in the Carbon-Enhanced Metal-Poor Star BD+44°493
2016, **The Astrophysical Journal Letters**, vol. 824, 19 (ADS)

2. Meléndez, J., **Placco, V. M.**, Tucci-Maia, M., Ramírez, I., Li, T. S., Perez, G.,
2MASS J1808−5104: The Brightest (V=11.9) Ultra Metal-Poor Star
2016, **Astronomy & Astrophysics - Letter to the Editor**, vol. 585, L5 (ADS)

1. Santucci, R. M., **Placco, V. M.**, Rossi, S., Beers, T. C., Reggiani, H. M., Lee, Y. S., Xue, X. X., Carollo, D.
The Frequency of Field Blue-Straggler Stars in the Thick Disk and Halo System of the Galaxy
2015, **The Astrophysical Journal**, vol. 801, 116 (ADS)

nth Author ($\star$ for relevant non-refereed publications)

132. Almeida-Fernandes, F., Limberg, G., Perottoni, H. D., Amarante, J. A. S., Bolutavicius, G. F., Cordeiro, V., Borges-Fernandes, M., **Placco, V. M.**, da Silva, A. R., Santos-Silva, T., Machado-Pereira, E., Santucci, R. M., Menendez, K., Gonçalves, T., Rossi, S., Kanaan, A., Schoenell, W., Ribeiro, T., Mendes de Oliveira, C.
The Metallicity Gradient of Sagittarius Dwarf Spheroidal Galaxy Prior to Infall Constrained by S-PLUS Observations of its Tidal Stream
2026, **The Astrophysical Journal**, submitted

131. Do, H. Q., Chiti, A., Ferguson, P. S., Ji, A. P., Limberg, G., Atzberger, K. R., Carlin, J. L., Cerny, W., Drlica-Wagner, A., Lewis, G. F., Li, T. S., Martínez-Vázquez, C. E., Martell, S. L., Medina, G. E., Noel, N. E. D., Pace, A. B., **Placco, V. M.**, Riley, A. H., Sand, D. J., Stringfellow, G. S., Carballo-Bello, J. A., Cullinane, L. R., Erkal, D., Koposov, S. E., Mutlu-Pakdil, B., Navabi, M., Shipp, N., Vivas, A. K., Zenteno, A., Zucker, D.
The DECam MAGIC Survey: Investigating the Jet Stellar Stream with Photometric Metallicities
2026, **The Astrophysical Journal**, submitted

130. Shah, S. P., Ezzeddine, R., Holmbeck, E. M., Ji, A. P., **Placco, V. M.**, Roederer, I. U., Mardini, M. K., Usman, S. A., Bandyopadhyay, A., Beers, T. C., Frebel, A., Hansen, T. T., Sakari, C. M., Sneden, C.
The R-*Process Alliance: Actinide Abundances, Variation, and Evolution in Metal-Poor Stars*
2026, **The Astrophysical Journal**, submitted

129. Martínez-Solaeche, G., González Delgado, R. M., García-Benito, R., Hernan-Caballero, A., Perez-Rafols, I., Diaz-Garcia, L. A., Abramo, L. R., Rodriguez-Martin, J. E., Conrado, A. M., Breda, I., Dominguez Sanchez, H., Marquez, I., Pieri, M., Lopez-Cano, D., **Placco, V. M.**, et al.
OJALÁ: Optimizing J-PAS Astronomy for Large-scale Analysis. A foundation model for the SED of galaxies, QSOs and stars
2026, **Astronomy & Astrophysics**, submitted

128. Aguilar, J. F., Cruz, P., Solano, E., Coelho, P. R. T., Ederoclite, A., **Placco, V. M.**, Mas-Buitrago, P., Alvarez-Candal, A., Cenarro, A. J., Cristobal-Hornillos, D., Hernandez-Monteagudo, C., Lopez-Sanjuan, C., Marin-Franch, A., Moles, M., Varela, J., Vazquez Ramio, H., Alcaniz, J., Dupke, R. A., Sodre, L., Jr, Angulo, R. E.
Stellar characterization with photometric colors from J-PLUS and 2MASS surveys
2026, **Astronomy & Astrophysics**, submitted

127. Mardini, M. K., Frebel, A., **Placco, V. M.**, Chiti, A., MAnolia, Y., Beers, T., Ezzeddine, R., Hansen, T. T., Holmbeck, E. M., Roederer, I. U., Sakari, C. M.
The R-process Alliance: A Bright, Strongly R-process-enhanced Extremely Metal-poor Star Observed with GHOST
2026, **The Astrophysical Journal**, submitted

126. Atzberger, K. R., Pace, A. B., Kallivayalil, N., Chiti, A., Erkal, D., Cerny, W., Limberg, G., **Placco, V. M.**, et al.
The DECam MAGIC Survey: Uncovering the Tidal Tails of the Crater II Dwarf Galaxy
2026, **The Astrophysical Journal**, submitted

125. Venn, K. A., Yuan, Z., Martin, N. F., Dovgal, A., Zaremba, Daria., Starkenburg, E., Gran, F., Hayes, C. R., Hill, V., Kobayashi, C., Lardo, C., McConnachie, A. W., Matsuno, T., Montelius, M., **Placco, V. M.**, et al.
The primordial nature of the C-19 stellar stream
2026, **Nature Astronomy**, submitted

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